Part Two

Professional Ethics

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Work experience is good.
Work ethic is better.

If you have work ethic, work experience will follow!

Work ethic can take you places experience can't.

You can't grow much unless your foundation is strong.



The Concept of Professional Work

What is a Professional?

The term professional refers to anyone who earns their living from performing an activity that requires a certain level of education, skill, or training.

There is typically a required standard of competency, knowledge, or education that must be demonstrated (often in the form of an exam or qualification), as well as adhering to codes of conduct and ethical standards.

Types of Professionals

There are many different types of professionals. Whether they are athletes or business people, there are many categories and groups, which are listed below.

Types of professionals include:

Accountant, Teacher, Technician, Laborer, Physician, Commercial Banker, Engineer Lawyer, Psychologist, Pharmacist, Research Analyst, Mechanic, Dentist, Electrician, Consultant, Investment Banker, Programmer etc.

Professional Standards

Professional standards are a set of **practices, ethics, and behaviors** that members of a particular professional group must adhere to.

These sets of standards are frequently agreed to by a governing body that represents the interests of the group.

Examples of professional standards include:

- **Accountability**: Takes responsibility for their actions.
- **Confidentiality**: Keeps all sensitive information private and away from those who shouldn't have access to it.
- **Honesty**: Always being truthful.
- **Integrity**: Having strong moral principles.
- **Law-abiding**: Follows all governing laws in the authorities they perform activities.
- **Loyalty**: Remain committed to their profession.
- **Objectivity**: Not persuaded or influenced by biases.
- **Transparency**: Revealing all relevant information and not hiding anything.

Professional Vs. Amateur

A professional performs an activity to earn a living and has demonstrated a certain level of competence or earned a credential, whereas an amateur performs an activity as a hobby, pastime, or without compensation.

Examples of amateurs include:

Amateur athletes, amateur theater and amateur photography.

Professional jobs (Designations) include:

Teachers, doctors/surgeons/dentists, accountants, lawyers, engineers, architects, artists/authors and designers.

Job Functions

Key performance indicators related directly to your specific job functions will be appraised during an evaluation, but this particular area will vary based on your role and responsibilities. Key performance indicators might include:

- Timeliness (rightness)
- Attention to detail.
- Creativity and innovation.
- Good time management.
- Ability to perform in all key areas of role.
- Consistency
- Initiative

Job Functions

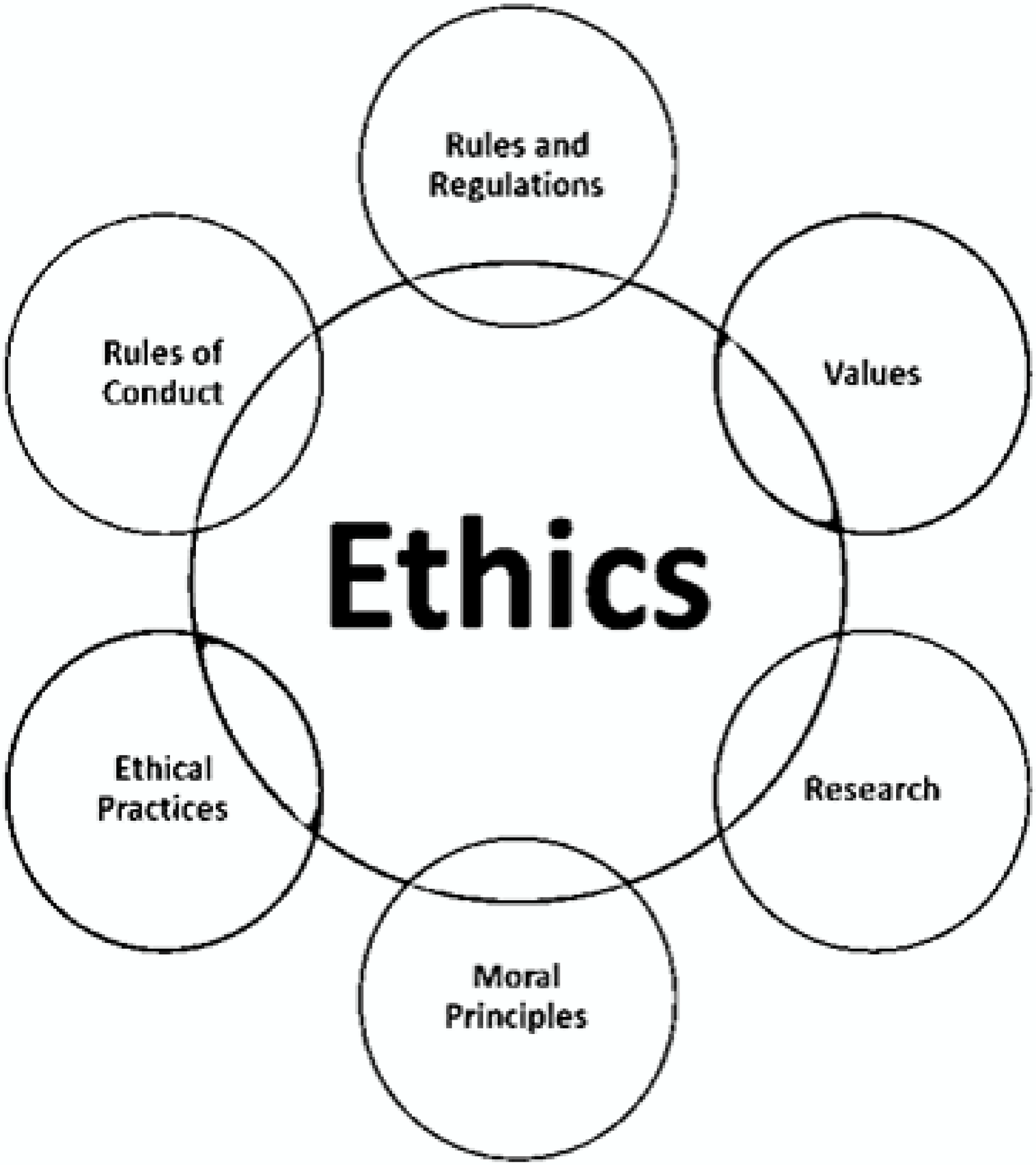
Employers will also assess if you have met pre-established goals during the time period between appraisals. These are typically specific to your individual job function and may include anything from learning a new software program to leading a team effort or hitting an earnings goal.

Definition of Professional Ethics

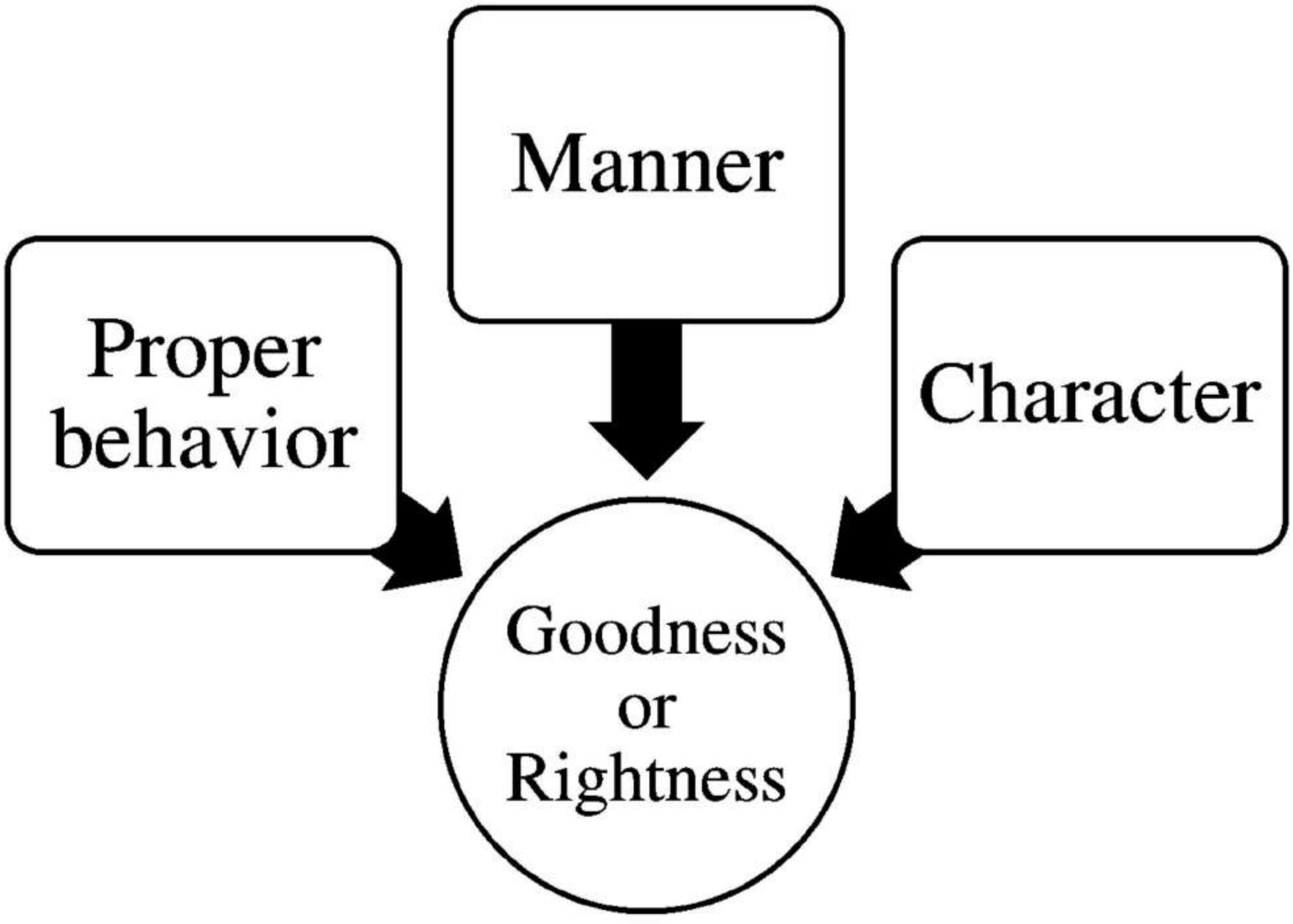
Meaning of Ethics:

Rational (sensible), optimal (ideal) and appropriate (suitable) decision, behavior and response on the basis of commonly desired values, preferences and expectations with effect of rightness.

Set of standards of conduct and moral judgments to determine "rightness" and "wrongness" in behavior and action.

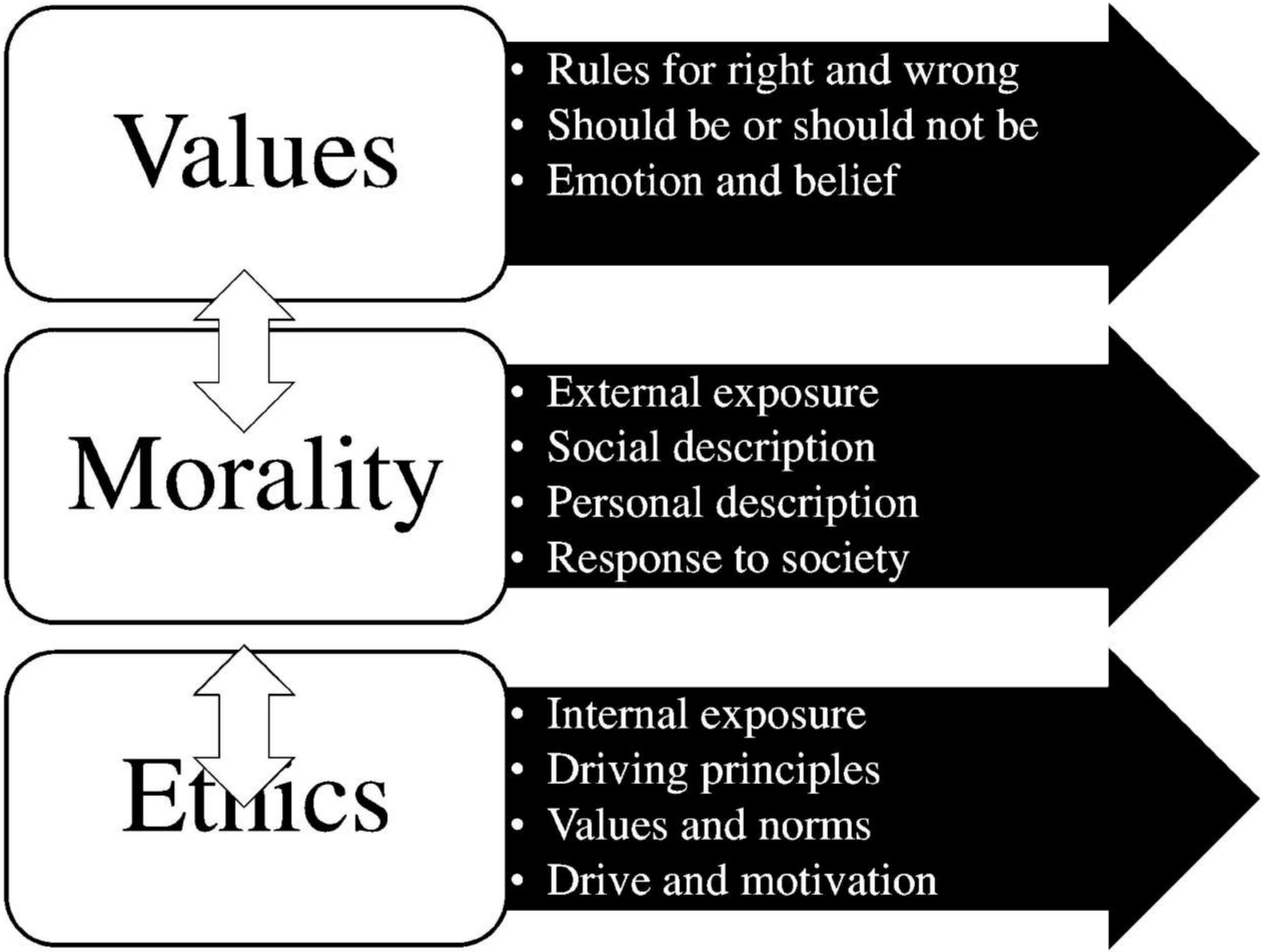

Rules and Regulations
Rules of Conduct
Values
Ethics
Ethical Practices
Research
Moral Principles

Morality: Response to Externality



Values and Morals: Complementarity with Ethics

- Values are the rules by which we make decisions about right and wrong, should and should not, good or bad, feasible or infeasible, and so on.
- Morals have a greater social element to values and tend to have a very broad acceptance. These are the people's fundamental beliefs and motivational basis for ethical judgment in social condition.


Values
Rules for right and wrong
Should be or should not be
Emotion and belief
Morality
External exposure
Social description
Personal description
Response to society
Ethics
Internal exposure
Driving principles
Values and norms
Drive and motivation

The Sources of Professional Ethics



Principled Ethics

- Values and intentions
- Good principles lead to ethical behavior and actions

Responsive Ethics

- Consequentialism
- Result, impact and outcome lead to ethical behavior
- Accountability

Types of Ethics

- **Ethics of Principled Conviction**
  - Asserts that intent is the most important factor.
  - Good principles enforce ethical act.

- **Ethics of Responsibility**
  - Outcome or consequence oriented ethics.
  - Not dependent on high-minded principles.

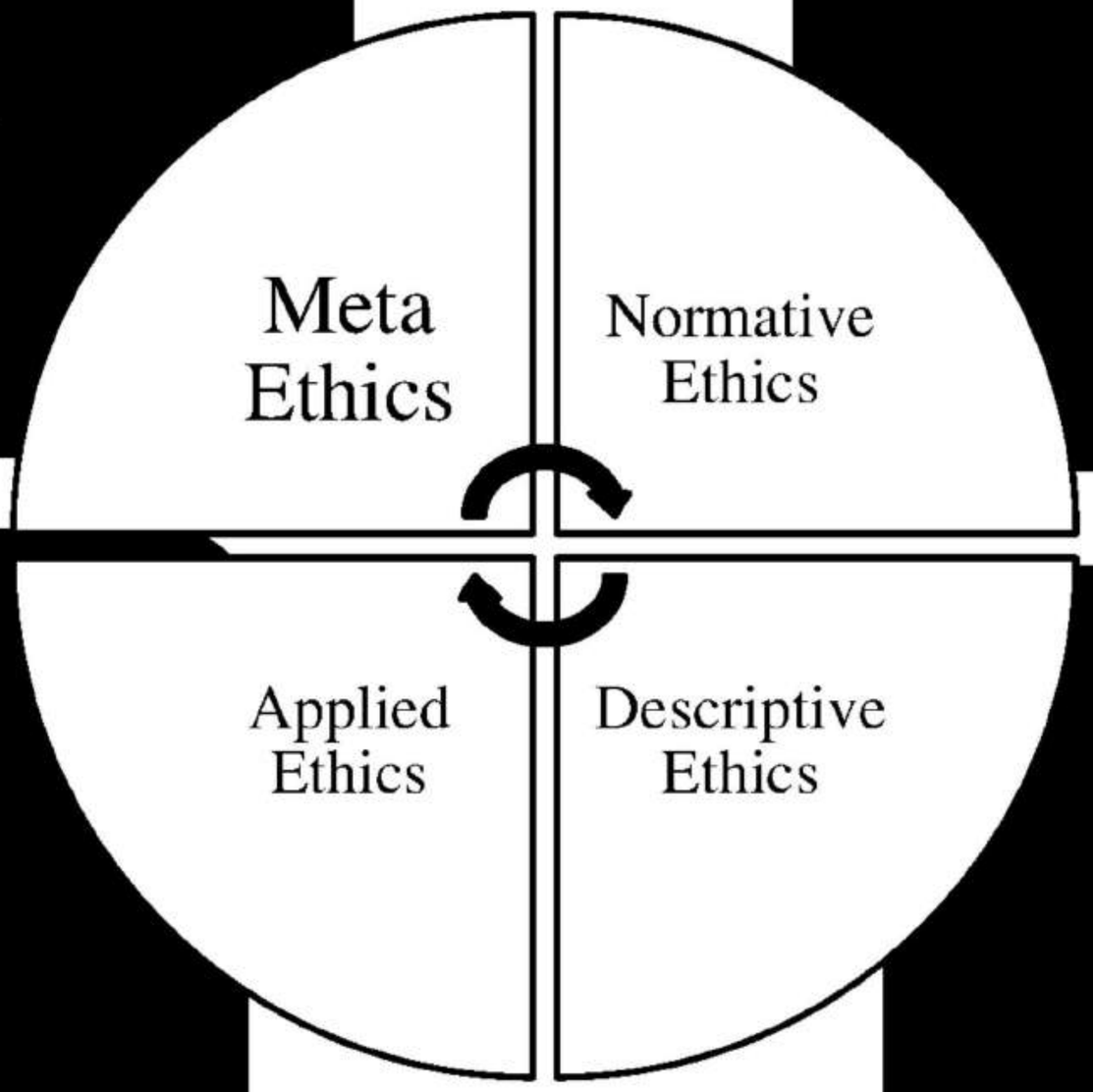
Scope of Ethics

- **Meta Ethics**: About the theoretical meaning and reference of moral propositions and how their truth values may be determined
- **Normative Ethics**: Value for service, development, quality outputs, productivity, competitiveness.
- **Descriptive Ethics:** Value-free approach to ethics like "ethical codes", common pattern of behavior irrespective of real life situations. Prescriptive rather than normative ethics.
- **Applied Ethics**: How moral outcomes can be achieved in specific situations

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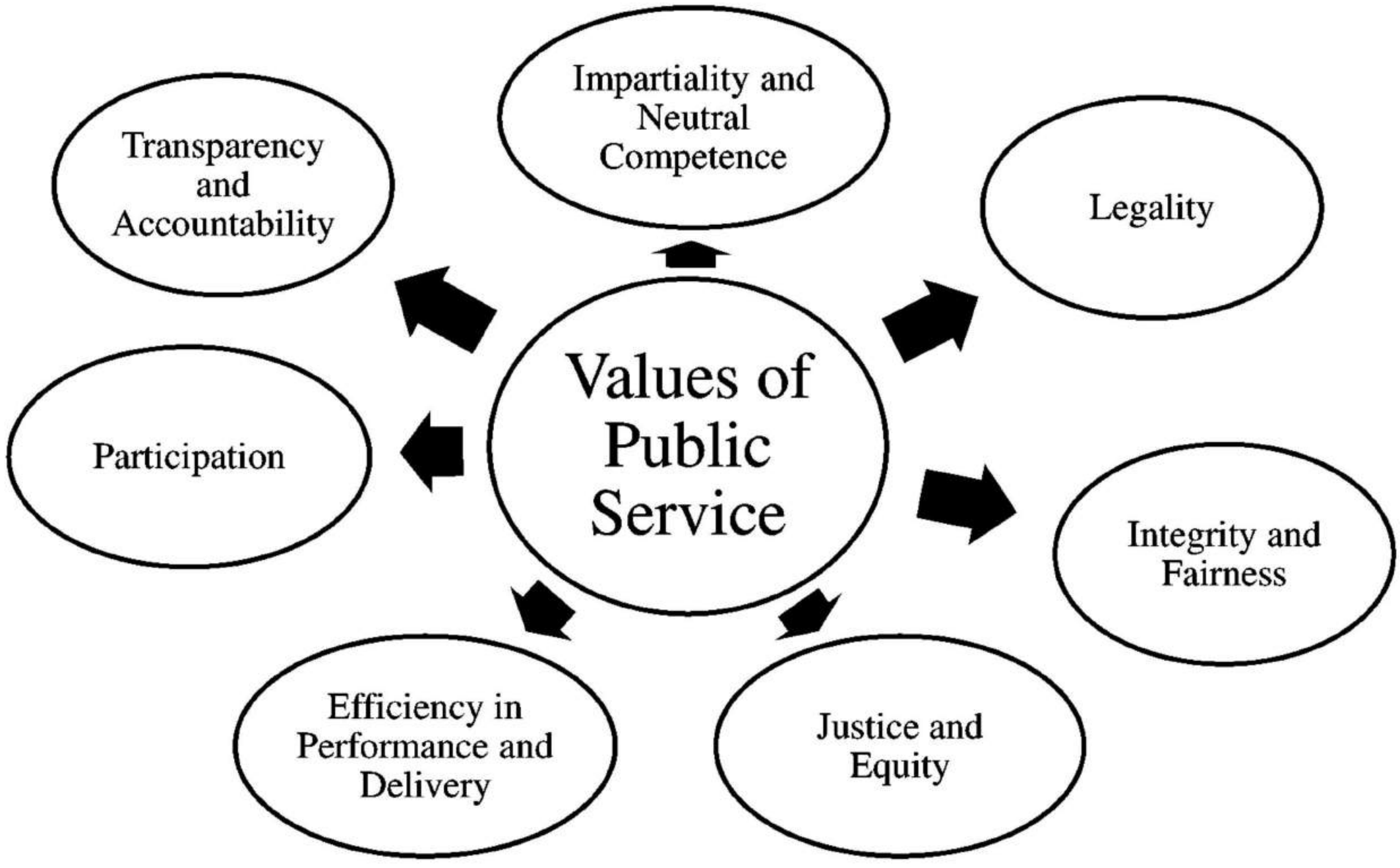
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Basic Principles of Ethics

- Utility principle
- Rights principle
- Fairness principle: Impartiality and neutrality
- Social justice principle: Equity
- Professional competency principle
- Efficiency principle
- Accountability principle

Public Service Values



Ethics in Public Service Profession: Basic Principles

- Clear ethical standards.
- Legal framework: Adequate and appropriate.
- Ethical guidance for public servants.
- Knowledge of rights, obligations and consequences to public servants.
- Political reinforcement to public service ethics.
- Public inspection and transparency of decision making process.
- Guidelines for interaction between public and private sectors.
- Policy, institution, systems and methods for promoting ethics.
- Adequate and appropriate accountability mechanisms.
- Appropriate authorization against non-compliance and unethical behavior.


Protection
Recognition
Performance
Improving Professional Ethics
Development
Motivation

Acceptable behavior

Minimum standard all staff are expected to:

- Work co-operatively with others in order to achieve objectives
- Manage performance in an appropriate and fair manner.
- Give and receive constructive feedback as part of normal day-to-day work.
- Consider other people's perspectives in order to help reach agreement
- Establish good working relationships

Acceptable and Unacceptable Professional Behaviour

Unacceptable behavior

Unacceptable behavior (including mistreatment, harassment and abuse), may involve actions, words or physical gestures that could reasonably be perceived to be the cause of another person's distress or discomfort. Mistreatment or harassment may be by an individual against an individual or involve groups of people.

Acceptable and Unacceptable Professional Behaviour

Unacceptable behavior does not have to be face-to-face, and may take many forms such as written, telephone or e-mail communications or through social media.

Some examples of unacceptable behavior are:

- Aggressive or abusive behavior, such as shouting or personal insults
- Spreading malicious rumors or gossip, or insulting someone
- Discrimination or harassment when related to a protected characteristic under the Equality Act
- Unwanted physical contact
- Offensive comments/jokes or body language

Acceptable and Unacceptable Professional Behaviour

- Publishing, circulating or displaying pornographic, racist, sexually suggestive or otherwise offensive material or pictures
- Isolation, deliberate exclusion and/or non co-operation at work
- Persistent and unreasonable criticism
- Unreasonable demands and impossible targets
- Force, such as pressure to subscribe to a particular political or religious belief
- Some forms of unacceptable behavior may be serious enough to constitute a criminal offence.

Professional ethics and codes of conduct

The sources of professional ethics and reasons for non-compliance with professional ethics

Professional ethics are principles that govern the behavior of a person or group in a business environment, like values.

Professional ethics provide rules on how a person should act towards other people and institutions.

Ethical Principles

Different forms of professions and the importance of their relationship to ethic

Ethical principles support all professional codes of conduct. Ethical principles may differ depending on the profession; for example, professional ethics that relate to medical practitioners will differ from those that relate to lawyers or real estate agents.

However, there are some universal ethical principles that apply across all professions, including:

Ethical Principles

- Honesty
- Trustworthiness
- Loyalty
- Respect for others
- Adherence to the law
- Doing good and avoiding harm to others
- Accountability.

Codes of conduct

Professional codes of conduct draw on these professional ethical principles as the basis for prescribing required standards of behavior for members of a profession. They also seek to set out the expectations that the profession and society have of its members.

Codes of conduct

The intention of codes of conduct is to provide guidelines for the minimum standard of appropriate behavior in a professional context.

Codes of conduct sit alongside the general law of the land and the personal values of members of the profession.

Value of a Professional Code

The primary value of a professional code of conduct is not as a checklist for disciplining non-conforming members, although breaks of a code of conduct usually do carry a professional disciplinary consequence. Rather, its primary value is to act as a prompt sheet for the promotion of ethical decision-making by members of that profession.

Professional codes of conduct provide benefits to:

- The public, as they build confidence in the profession's trustworthiness
- Clients, as they provide greater transparency and certainty about how their affairs will be handled

- Members of the profession, as they provide a supporting framework for resisting pressure to act inappropriately, and for making acceptable decisions in the profession as a whole, as they provide a common understanding of acceptable practice which builds collegiality and allows for fairer disciplinary procedures.
- Others dealing with the profession, as the profession will be seen as more reliable and easier to deal with.
- Realize what may be grey areas.

Professional Code of Ethics: Definition and Examples

A professional code of ethics offers a set of guidelines teams or organizations can use to make good decisions in the workplace. It allows you to set a baseline expectation for what is socially acceptable and how professionals should approach problems. Though creating and maintaining a professional code of ethics takes some time, it can help your organization's employees work honestly and with integrity, which can help create a healthier work environment.

Professional Code of Ethics: Definition and Examples

What is a professional code of ethics?

A professional code of ethics is a set of principles designed to help a business govern its decision-making and distinguish right from wrong. Often referred to as an ethical code, these principles outline the mission and values of an organization, how the professionals within the organization are supposed to approach problems and the standards to which employees are held.

Professional Code of Ethics: Definition and Examples

Why is a code of ethics important?

A professional code of ethics is designed to ensure employees are behaving in a manner that is socially acceptable and respectful of one another. It establishes the rules for behavior and sends a message to every employee that universal compliance is expected. It also provides the groundwork for a preventive warning if employees break the code. A code of ethics can be valuable not just internally as a professional guide but also externally as a statement of a company's values and commitments.

Examples of a professional code of ethics

Here are some examples of a professional code of ethics in different professions:

Lawyers

"A lawyer shall provide competent representation to a client. Competent representation requires the legal knowledge, skill, thoroughness and preparation reasonably necessary for the representation."

Examples of a professional code of ethics

Physicians

Physicians are held to a universal code of conduct because of their chosen profession. The American Medical Association addresses everything from patient care to relationships with other staff members. For example:

- A physician shall provide competent medical care, with compassion and respect for human dignity and rights.
- A physician shall uphold the standards of professionalism, be honest in all professional interactions and strive to report physicians deficient in character or competence, or engaging in fraud or deception, to appropriate entities.
- A physician shall respect the law and recognize a responsibility to seek changes in those requirements which are contrary to the best interests of the patient.

Examples of a professional code of ethics

Teachers

Professional educators are typically held to a universal code of ethics that is designed to protect the rights of all students. The code of ethics can vary from school to school or differ slightly in each state, but the basic principles always remain the same:

Teachers are required to show impartiality, integrity and ethical behavior in the classroom and in their conduct with parents and colleagues.

How to develop a code of ethics

Here are the steps you can follow to create your own professional code of ethics for your company:

1. Set your priorities.
2. Ask employees for input.
3. Put someone in charge.
4. Have someone to turn to for help.

Standards of ethical behavior in Science and Engineering

Ten ethical principles common across scientific disciplines. They are:

1. **Duty to society**
2. **Beneficence (Goodness, Compassion and Kindness)**
3. **Conflict of interest**
4. **Informed consent** (A process in which patients are given important information, including possible risks and benefits, about a medical procedure or treatment, genetic testing, or a clinical trial. This is to help them decide if they want to be treated, tested, or take part in the trial).
5. **Integrity**
6. **Nondiscrimination**
7. **Non-exploitation**
8. **Privacy and confidentiality**
9. **Professional competence**
10. **Professional discipline.**

Standards of ethical behavior in Science and Engineering

Each ethical principle applies to the scientific inquiry, the conduct and behaviors of researchers, or the ethical treatment of research participants.

Only one ethical principle -duty to society- applies to the scientific inquiry by asking whether the research benefits society.

Variations in ethical principles across disciplines are usually due to whether the discipline includes human or animal subjects.

Variations in ethical principles across countries are usually due to local laws, oversight, and enforcement; cultural norms; and whether research is conducted in the researchers' host country or a foreign country.

Leander ISD's 10 Ethical Principles

1. **Honesty**
   telling the truth
2. **Integrity**
   doing the right thing
3. **Promise-keeping**
   doing what you say you are going to do
4. **Loyalty**
   supporting someone or something
5. **Concern for Others**
   caring for and helping others
6. **Law-abidance/Civic Duty**
   obeying rules and laws/ making the world a better place
7. **Respect for Others**
   being polite and kind to everyone and everything
8. **Fairness**
   treating everyone equally
9. **Pursuit of Excellence**
   doing everything the best you can; looking for ways to improve
10. **Accountability**
    admitting to what you do wrong, and taking pride in what you do right

Professional Ethics in Jordanian Laws and Regulations
Jordan: Jordanian Code of Conduct

Jordanian government announced a new Ministerial Code of Conduct for the governance of conduct and the avoidance of conflict of interest. The new code applied to Cabinet members and Ministers.

The new Code of Conduct is abiding agreement provides that Ministers, in the fulfillment of the obligations in their executive role, must do so without having any conflict of interest.

Jordan: Jordanian Code of Conduct

The new Conduct ensures a commitment by the Ministers in decently executing their duties, while continuously upholding the interests of the public as a whole and the good morals of the public.

The Conduct also provides for the avenues and necessity of doing such, for any Minister or government employee to disclose any potential conflicts of interest that might arise during their service within the government.

Jordan: Jordanian Code of Conduct

Each Ministry included within their scope of work – the integration of the code of conduct within their entire scope of projects, programs and plans.

This inclusion is done in conjunction with the upholding of the Kingdom's policy and maintaining its national goals.

Jordan: Jordanian Code of Conduct

In addition to the provisions regulating the Ministers of government, the code of conduct also provides the laws which oblige the Prime Minister and the members of his Council.

Such laws ensure that they accept the rule of law, act in full transparency, disclose any conflicts of interest, reveal all previous professionals and investments and perform their tasks with integrity, efficiency, fairness, and equality.

Jordan: Jordanian Code of Conduct

The code also provides for the duties and responsibilities of the Ministers.

It incorporates a provision that provides that Ministers be able to accept ordinary official or honorary gifts and other forms of appreciation, but such Ministers are not entitled to accept or to seek any gift, benefit or other allowance.

It provides for the disclosure by the Ministers of gifts provided to them the exceed 50 Dinars. Any such gifts will be considered public funds and property to be transferred to the Department of General Supplies.

Jordan: Jordanian Code of Conduct

The code also provides for the control of the conduct of influence in that Ministers will not be able to use their influence to benefit themselves, family members, or other related bodies.

Jordan: Jordanian Code of Conduct

The Minister may not utilize information gained by Ministers in the fulfillment of their duties once they have left their Ministerial duties and they must wait one year after leaving the office to engage in contractual relations with the Ministry that they entered.

Lastly, their family members or relatives must not trade in the shares of companies they are responsible for or benefit from the material and non-public information

Examples: Jordanian Code of Conduct

- مدونة قواعد السلوك الوظيفي واخلاقيات الوظيفة العامة في الاردن.
- ميثاق آداب وأخلاقيات ممارسة مهنة الهندسة.
- مدونة قواعد السلوك الوظيفي واخلاقيات الوظيفة في جامعة البلقاء التطبيقية.